Be a Word Architect

Vocabulary Words

biannual	**octagonal**
biceps	**octopus**
bifocals	**triangular**
binoculars	**triathlon**
biweekly	**tricycle**
multicolored	**tripod**
multimillionaire	**tristate**
multitude	

Word Learning Tip!

When you come to a long word, it is helpful to see if you know the meaning of any parts of that word. For example, a prefix always comes at the beginning of a word. It carries a meaning that doesn't change no matter what word or word root it is added to. Knowing the meaning of prefixes can help you determine the meaning of many unknown words.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Prefixes A prefix is a letter or group of letters added to the beginning of a word or root to change its meaning. You can often learn the meaning of words you don't know by adding together the meaning of the prefix and the word or word root it was added to. Then check if the meaning makes sense in the sentence.

Learn More!

You know something right away about all words that begin with the prefix *bi-*: They all contain the meaning "two." Words that begin with the prefix *tri-* all contain the meaning "three." Words with the prefix *oct-*, which is also spelled *octa-* or *octo-*, all contain the meaning "eight." Words with the prefix *multi-* all contain the meaning "many."

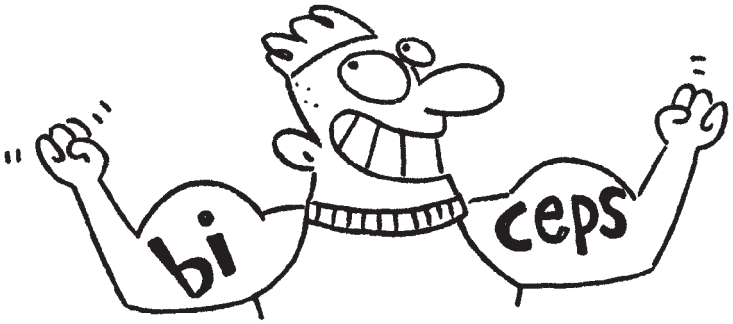
Prefix	Meaning
bi-	two
tri-	three
oct-/octa-/octo-	eight
multi-	many

You can add a prefix to a word:

tri + state = tristate

You can add a prefix to a word root (a word part that carries the word's basic meaning but cannot stand alone):

bi + ceps = biceps



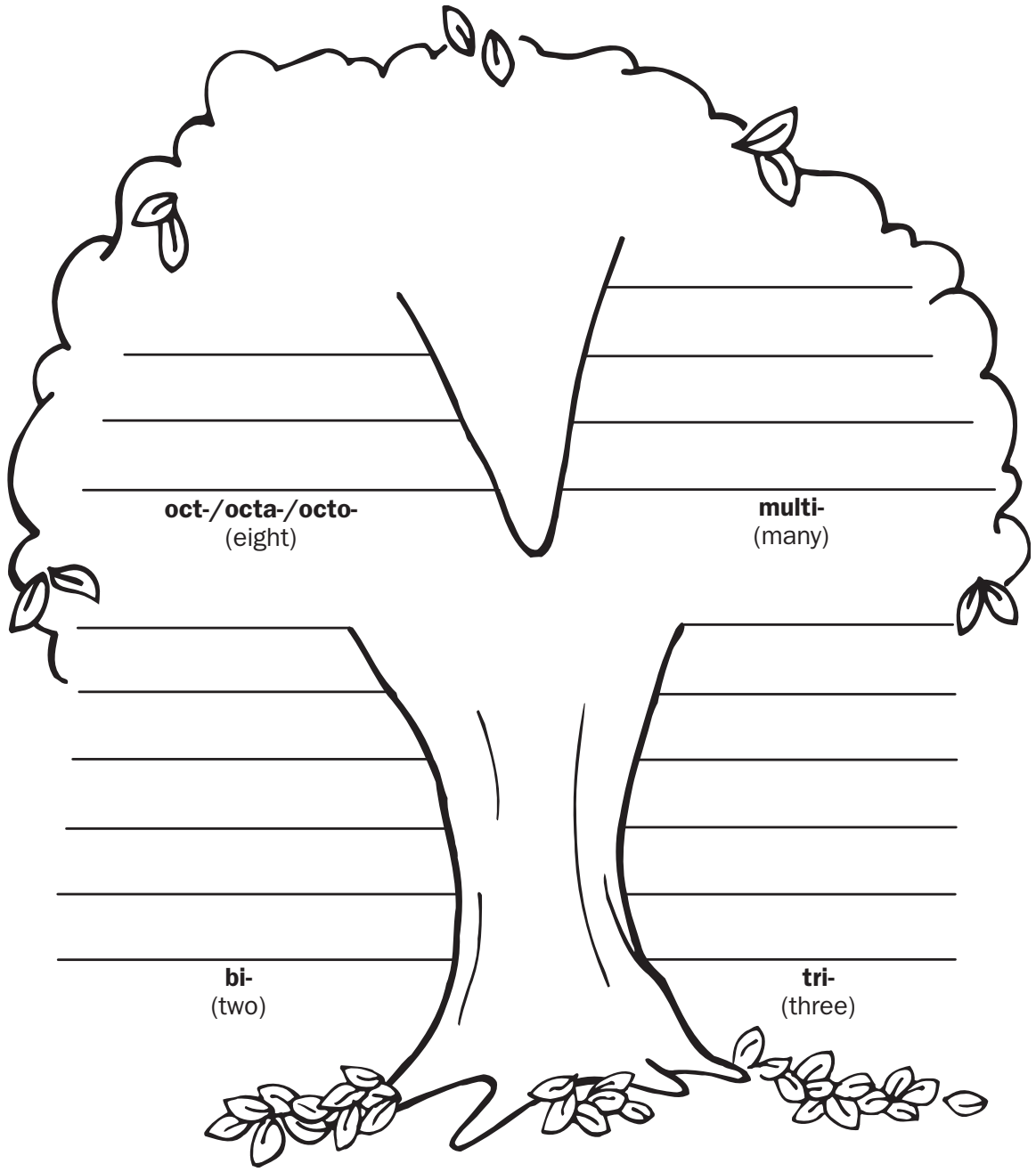
Find New Words Look in a dictionary. Find one new word for each of these prefixes: *bi-, oct-/octa-/octo-, tri-, multi-*. First place the word on the prefix tree on page 79. Then write each word and its meaning in your personal word journal. Finally, write a sentence using each word.

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biannual	**binoculars**	**multimillionaire**	**octopus**	**tricycle**
biceps	**biweekly**	**multitude**	**triangular**	**tripod**
bifocals	**multicolored**	**octagonal**	**triathlon**	**tristate**

Directions Look at each branch of the prefix tree below. Place each vocabulary word in the blank on the correct branch. Circle the prefix in each word.



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Connect Words and Meanings

biannual	**binoculars**	**multimillionaire**	**octopus**	**tricycle**
biceps	**biweekly**	**multitude**	**triangular**	**tripod**
bifocals	**multicolored**	**octagonal**	**triathlon**	**tristate**

Directions Study each definition. Then write a sentence to answer the question that follows the definition. Use the vocabulary word in your response.

1. **triathlon** a long-distance race that is made up of three events. Usually, these include swimming, bicycling, and running.
   If a race is made up of ten events, can it be called a **triathlon**? Explain why or why not.
   _____

2. **biweekly** happening twice a week or once every two weeks
   If a newspaper comes out on Mondays and Fridays, is it published **biweekly**? Explain why or why not. _____

3. **octagonal** having eight sides or eight angles
   If a building is shaped like a square, does it have an **octagonal** shape? Explain why or why not. _____

4. **multicolored** having many colors
   If you order a **multicolored** tee-shirt, will it have one color or many colors? Explain.
   _____

5. **bifocals** eyeglasses with two different sections of each lens, one for seeing things up close and one for seeing things farther away
   If your grandfather needs glasses only for reading, does he need **bifocals**? Explain why or why not. _____

6. **multitude** a great many things or people
   If someone were running for office, would that person want to speak to a **multitude**? Explain why or why not. _____

7. **octopus** a sea animal with eight long tentacles or arms
   If an **octopus** caught one diver in each of its tentacles, how many divers would it catch? Explain how you know.
   _____

8. **tripod** a three-legged stand or stool
   If you found four marks indicating where the grass had been crushed, would you conclude that someone had been sitting on a **tripod**? Explain why or why not.
   _____

Continued on next page

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Connect More Words and Meanings

biannual	**binoculars**	**multimillionaire**	**octopus**	**tricycle**
biceps	**biweekly**	**multitude**	**triangular**	**tripod**
bifocals	**multicolored**	**octagonal**	**triathlon**	**tristate**

Directions Continue the activity. Study each definition. Then write a sentence to answer the question that follows the definition. Use the vocabulary word in your response.

9. biannual happening twice a year or once every two years
If you plan a party for your parents' anniversary, do you help them celebrate a **biannual** event? Explain why or why not.

10. tristate involving three states
If you live in the **tristate** area, how many other states are nearby? Explain.

11. biceps the large set of muscles in the front of your upper arm between your shoulder and inner elbow.
Why might you roll up your sleeve and flex your **biceps**?

12. multimillionaire person with many millions of dollars
Would you rather be a **multimillionaire** or a millionaire? Explain why.

13. triangular having three sides or angles
If a game board has a **triangular** shape and each player starts in one corner, how many players would there be? Explain how you know.

14. binoculars a device used with both eyes to see things that are very far away
When would you be likely to use **binoculars**? Explain.

15. tricycle a vehicle with pedals that has three wheels, one in the front and two in the back
Why would a small child be likely to ride a **tricycle**?

Exploring Word Meaning The word *biannual* can mean two very different things. It can mean "happening two times a year" or "happening every two years." In your personal word journal, write two sentences. Use a different meaning of *biannual* in each sentence. Make sure the context indicates which meaning you intend for each usage of this word.

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Learn Words in Context

biannual	**binoculars**	**multimillionaire**	**octopus**	**tricycle**
biceps	**biweekly**	**multitude**	**triangular**	**tripod**
bifocals	**multicolored**	**octagonal**	**triathlon**	**tristate**

Explore Summer in the Tristate Area!



There's so much to do in the **tristate** area in the summer. You can swim in one of a **multitude** of lakes or visit one of our ocean beaches. Or you can ride your bicycle along our miles and miles of bike paths. There are even special paths for small children who ride **tricycles**.

If you enjoy nature, dust off your **binoculars** and go bird-watching. Look carefully to spot beautiful **multicolored** birds. If you have a guidebook, don't forget to bring along your **bifocals** so you can read the fine print and look for birds at the same time.

Do you like country fairs? Some towns have fairs twice a year as a **biannual** event, while others hold them just once a year. Fairs often sponsor old-fashioned games, such as three-legged races and ring-tosses. One ring-toss game that amuses me looks like an **octopus**. Put a ring on each of the game's eight legs and you win.

If there's a **triathlon**, you may want to enter one or all of the three sporting events. Since I have strong **biceps**, I usually do well in the swimming part of the competition.

Some towns hold **biweekly** air shows when it is sunny outside. You may see old-fashioned planes flying alongside modern ones. You'll get some exciting pictures. Be sure to put your camera on a **tripod** to keep it steady. Perhaps you'll even spot a rich and famous **multimillionaire** walking by!

Visit one of our outdoor sculpture gardens and you'll see the most unusual forms. One sculpture consists of a series of eight tubes joined together to form an **octagonal** structure. Put some siding on this and you may have the house of the future. Another shows three plastic **triangular** forms tilted so that the tops touch. Their amazing balancing act will make you marvel.

There's something for everyone, so head out for fun in the tristate area!

Write Slogans Imagine that you work for the state visitors' office. Write slogans that will make people want to visit your state. Fold a piece of paper into three long strips. Write one slogan on each strip. Be sure to use at least three vocabulary words in your slogans.

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Use Words in Context

biannual	**binoculars**	**multimillionaire**	**octopus**	**tricycle**
biceps	**biweekly**	**multitude**	**triangular**	**tripod**
bifocals	**multicolored**	**octagonal**	**triathlon**	**tristate**

Directions Choose the correct word to complete each sentence. Write it in the blank.

Dear Mike,

I just bought a kite that has a **(1)**_____ (*triangular, tripod, multicolored*) shape. It has three angles and three sides. It's bright red and orange. Tomorrow I'm going kite flying on the beach. Since it's autumn, the trees along the path to the beach are bright with **(2)**_____ (*multitude, multicolored, multimillionaire*) leaves. I use **(3)**_____ (*biweekly, bifocals, binoculars*) to watch large fish jump in the ocean. My younger sister will ride along beside me on her **(4)**_____ (*tricycle, tripod, triathlon*).

My older brother completed the **(5)**_____ (*triathlon, triangular, tristate*) yesterday. He had a great time, but he's glad it's a **(6)**_____ (*bifocals, biweekly, biannual*) event and not held every year. Every other year is more than enough for him! He's very strong—you should see his **(7)**_____ (*biceps, bifocals, biweekly*)—but in spite of his firm muscles, even he was tired.

My father's **(8)**_____ (*tricycle, tripod, octagonal*) broke, so he had to hold his camera rather than put it on the stand. Don't worry! We still have a **(9)**_____ (*multicolored, multimillionaire, multitude*) of pictures to look at.

It's really fun to vacation in the three states that make up the **(10)**_____ (*tristate, triangular, biannual*) area!

Your friend,

Marti

Write a Postcard Imagine you are on vacation. On a separate piece of paper, write a postcard. Think about what's special about the place you are visiting. What's your favorite place to eat? What are your favorite activities? Brainstorm some ideas with a partner. Use three vocabulary words in your postcard. Draw and label a picture of your vacation spot. Address the postcard, too!

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Review and Extend

biannual	**binoculars**	**multimillionaire**	**octopus**	**tricycle**
biceps	**biweekly**	**multitude**	**triangular**	**tripod**
bifocals	**multicolored**	**octagonal**	**triathlon**	**tristate**

Directions Use your knowledge of prefixes to answer each question below.

New Words

biathlon **bicycle** **tricolored** **triweekly**

1. If a **tricycle** has three wheels, how many wheels does a **bicycle** have? _____
2. If a **triathlon** has three events, how many events does a **biathlon** have? _____
3. If a **multicolored** flag has many different colors, how many different colors does a **tricolored** flag have? _____
4. If a **biweekly** meeting happens twice a week, how many times a week does a **triweekly** meeting occur? _____
5. If **biceps** are a set of two-headed muscles, how many heads do **triceps** have? (Triceps are the muscles that run along the back of your upper arm.) _____

Directions Use your knowledge of prefixes to answer each question below.

New Words

bilingual **multinational** **multiplex** **octet** **trident**

6. How many singers would be in an **octet**? _____
7. How many different movie theaters would a **multiplex** cinema have? _____
8. How many languages would a person who is **bilingual** speak? _____
9. How many nations would be involved in a **multinational** project? _____
10. In Roman myths, the god Neptune carries a **trident**—a spear that has how many prongs? _____

Write a Sentence Choose two of the new words. In your personal word journal, write a sentence using both words.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Circle the letter of the correct answer to each question below.

1. Who would be most likely to carry **binoculars**?
- **A.** a chef
- **B.** a soccer player
- **C.** a doctor
- **D.** a bird watcher

2. Who would most likely enter a **triathlon**?
- **A.** a person who likes poetry
- **B.** a person who likes music
- **C.** a person who is a good athlete
- **D.** a person who is not a good athlete

3. Why would a person most likely wear **bifocals**?
- **A.** to build a sand castle
- **B.** to see better
- **C.** to sleep more soundly
- **D.** to dress up for parties

4. How many states would be in a **tristate** area?
- **A.** three
- **B.** four
- **C.** thirteen
- **D.** thirty

5. What would you most likely use a **tripod** for?
- **A.** entertaining children
- **B.** removing snow
- **C.** holding up a camera
- **D.** cooking rice

Directions Read each item below. Choose the word that best fits in each blank. Write it on the line.

6. If you were a deep-sea diver, you might see a(n) _____ (*octopus, octagonal, biweekly*) around a shipwreck.

7. If you lift weights every day, you will have well-developed _____ (*biceps, bifocals, biannual*).

8. Most tents have a _____ (*multicolored, triangular, multitude*) shape.

9. The _____ (*multimillionaire, tripod, biannual*) donated a lot of money to build a new art museum.

10. The three-year-old child likes riding on a _____ (*octagonal, tricycle, biceps*) all by himself.

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